"the more stable this association, the more tasks we resolve jointly, the more authoritative will be the BRICS international role."[107] Chinese Vice Minister of Finance Zhu Guangyao similarly observed in 2016 that "cooperation between the BRICS nations is expanding and deepening" and that "economic cooperation . . . has been built on a solid foundation, especially in the area of . . . financial infrastructure."[108]

Recalling Russia's prior experience in the G8, the director of policy planning in the Russian foreign ministry who helped flesh out the initial BRICs agendas stressed the usefulness of transgovernmental networks as then identified by his counterpart in the U.S. State Department, Anne Marie Slaughter, to coordinate preferences on multiple issues in a globalized world.[109] Then, thirty-four years after the G6 leaders' summit in Rambouillet, France, the four original BRICs met in Yekaterinburg in 2009 to officially announce their own new club and its objectives.

The BRICS have increasingly adapted their informal club into a more extensive set of relationships, and also have created new financial institutions paralleling and supplementing some of their Bretton Woods counterparts. As with other clubs, there are no public transcripts or accounts of the substantive meetings that take place among the principals at the ministerial level, behind closed doors, to forge common bargaining positions where deemed desirable. Nonetheless, it is possible to identify a number of cases in which the BRICS employed collective financial statecraft to achieve particular objectives, as well as some instances where they might have been expected to act but did not, as elaborated in Chapter 3.

One of their first moves, in 2009, was to coordinate stances among their finance ministers, central bankers, and foreign ministers to craft a common bargaining position where the BRICs would commit to provide additional funds to the IMF in the wake of the global financial crisis in return for significantly higher voting shares. U.S. Treasury Secretary Timothy Geithner reportedly requested permission to attend a BRICs meeting of finance ministers to discuss this proposal, which was a step in the direction of IMF voting reform that the White House broadly supported, at the expense of some overrepresented (mostly European) countries. Although the BRICs did not achieve all their voting share targets, and it took until the end of 2015 for the U.S. Congress to approve the IMF reform package, they successfully engaged collectively and gave the process a big shove. Their